

Saber Ayatollahi, CFA, MSc

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SUMMARY

Investment Director candidate with ~7 years across institutional investment research, portfolio risk analytics, and alternatives-focused due diligence at Moody's Analytics and Ortec Finance. Depth in VaR/CVaR portfolio optimization, risk decomposition, macroeconomic scenario analysis, and LDI across multi-asset mandates, with sign-off authority on outputs for portfolios of \$5-25bn per engagement. Fluent in Python and stochastic modelling; CFA charterholder with dual MSc in Financial Modelling and Chemical Engineering.

CORE SKILLS

Investment Research & Due Diligence • Portfolio Management & Optimization (VaR / CVaR) • Risk Decomposition & Performance Attribution • Macroeconomic Research & Scenario Analysis • Multi-Asset & Alternative Strategies • Financial Instruments & Derivatives Valuation • Investment Memoranda & Executive Briefs • Python & SQL for Investment Analysis • International Markets & Institutional Clients

EXPERIENCE

Moody's Analytics – Asset Management & Buy-Side Solutions

Asst. Director – Modelling Services (Investment & ALM Risk Lead)

Toronto, May 2023 - Present

Investment Analysis & Portfolio Oversight

- Hold delegated sign-off authority on valuation, sensitivity, and portfolio risk outputs for multi-asset institutional portfolios of \$5-25bn per engagement (\$50bn+ cumulative), independently reviewing curve construction, spread calibration, and cross-asset interactions.
- Validated derivatives valuation outputs across rates, FX, and inflation, ensuring consistency of sensitivities and scenario impacts at portfolio-level aggregates.
- Reviewed aggregation logic converting security-level exposures into portfolio-level risk metrics feeding downstream investment and capital processes.

Scenario Analysis & Executive Reporting

- Led design of a multi-asset cash-flow projection engine supporting base, stress, and reverse-stress scenarios, delivering forward-looking visibility across investment horizons.
- Prepared analytical summaries and periodic briefs for senior stakeholders on interest-rate exposure, scenario impacts, and balance-sheet sensitivities, translating quantitative outputs into investment-committee-ready narratives.
- Escalated outputs lacking economic defensibility, serving as escalation point on client-critical analytical issues for Heads of Risk and investment stakeholders.
- Re-engineered manual spreadsheet workflows into scalable, auditable Python (pandas, NumPy, SciPy) and SQL analytics pipelines; deployed agentic-AI workflows (Claude Code, Cursor) reducing development cycle time ~30-40% on comparable modules.

Client Service Specialist

Toronto, May 2022 - May 2023

- Led onboarding for U.S. and Canadian pension funds, asset managers, and consulting firms migrating to the PFaroe DB and PFaroe PM analytics platforms; translated investment-team requirements into structured development requests and validated model outputs post-deployment.
- Coordinated the full implementation lifecycle across multiple stakeholders, migrating all assigned client accounts from the legacy Calypso platform on schedule.

Ernst & Young (EY)

Senior Consultant – Financial Risk Transformation

Toronto, Sep 2021 - Apr 2022

- Delivered IFRS 17 and IFRS 9 transformation projects for Canadian and international insurance clients, aligning regulatory requirements with financial-reporting frameworks.

- Coordinated across actuarial, finance, IT, risk, and program-management teams on milestone delivery and governance documentation in multi-stakeholder environments.

Ortec Finance Canada

Consultant – Asset-Liability Management & Risk

Toronto, Feb 2019 - Sep 2021

- Performed asset-only and asset-liability (surplus) portfolio optimization on VaR and CVaR using Ortec's GLASS platform, with risk decomposition, risk budgeting, and near-optimal frontier analysis to test allocation robustness.
- Built and interpreted stochastic economic scenario generators to assess macroeconomic, interest-rate, and funding-volatility exposures under base-case and stressed environments.
- Delivered investment and ALM studies for Canadian and international pension funds and institutional investors across all major asset classes, covering duration, currency, and inflation exposures.
- Presented investment findings to investment committees on-site, advising on Strategic and Tactical Asset Allocation trade-offs via stress testing and sensitivity analysis.
- Modelled pension actuarial liabilities alongside major investment-product types and economic variables; led onboarding and the study for a three-plan university pension merger on a team of three.

EDUCATION & CREDENTIALS

- Chartered Financial Analyst (CFA) - CFA Institute, 2024
- MSc, Financial Modelling - Western University, 2018
- MSc, Chemical Engineering (Full Scholarship) - Western University, 2016